A motion was made by Corey Melancon and seconded by Carla JeanBatiste that the following resolution be adopted:

RESOLUTION NO. 26-017-RS

A RESOLUTION TO THE STATE OF LOUISIANA OPPOSING CLASS VI INJECTION WELLS DESIGNED FOR LONG-TERM GEOLOGIC SEQUESTRATION AND CAPTURING OF CARBON DIOXIDE GASES.

WHEREAS, the St. Martin Parish Council recognizes its fundamental duty to protect our local environment, land, and water resources for the health, safety, and welfare of our community; and

WHEREAS, it is the understanding of the St. Martin Parish Council that while state law directs the Louisiana Department of Energy and Natural Resources (LDENR) to give substantial consideration to local government input, it appears to the St. Martin Parish Council that local concerns are often not adequately acknowledged in the state's permitting process; and

WHEREAS, the St. Martin Parish Council has expressed its commitment to prioritizing the well-being of our residents through the enactment of local ordinances aimed at regulating injection wells to ensure community safety; and

WHEREAS, it is the belief of the St. Martin Parish Council there appears to be a disregard for community concerns by certain corporations, highlighting what it believes to be a prioritization of profits over public health and safety; and

WHEREAS, it has become evident to the St. Martin Parish Council that the LDENR appears to have no intent to provide necessary clarity regarding the long-term safety of injection wells nor provide adequate assurances to local governments regarding liability coverage should an accident occur; and

WHEREAS, it is the understanding of the St. Martin Parish Council that industry has failed to adequately address local emergency concerns, as the St. Martin Parish Council has not seen a comprehensive local Hazard Mitigation Plan submitted for review, nor has the St. Martin Parish Council been made aware of any formal contact with the local Homeland Security and Emergency Preparedness Director to coordinate a local emergency response plan; and

WHEREAS, it is the belief of the St. Martin Parish Council, that Class VI Carbon Capture and Storage (CCS) technologies and associated infrastructure present risks, including Co2 pipeline safety risks, groundwater contamination, induced seismicity and geological instability and long-term storage uncertainty and financial and liability risks; and

WHEREAS, it is the belief of the St. Martin Parish Council that siting industrial injection wells and pipeline infrastructure may have a negative impact on local property values and hinder future economic development opportunities; and

WHEREAS, St. Martin Parish is the home of a significant portion of the Atchafalaya Basin, a natural habitat which is vital to the economy of the Parish particularly, though not exclusively, from both environmental and tourism perspectives; and

WHEREAS, it is the entrenched concern of the St. Martin Parish Council that the Atchafalaya Basin is especially at peril because of the potential for the siting of injection wells and/or pipeline infrastructure associated with the construction and/or expansion of Carbon Capture and Storage facilities; and

WHEREAS, in spite of the risks and concerns referenced above, the industry has not adequately quantified or demonstrated to local residents nor local governments, public benefit resulting from these projects, and further, recent rule changes unjustifiably and substantially reduce the local taxable value of Co2 injection infrastructure.

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED, that the St. Martin Parish Council hereby reaffirms and expands its firm opposition to the permitting and establishment of any Class VI Injection Wells within the jurisdiction of St. Martin Parish, emphasizing our commitment to protecting the rights and interests of our community and the environment.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that the St. Martin Parish Council calls upon the Louisiana Legislature and the United States Congress to enact legislation that provides local communities with meaningful authority over injection well projects and establishes stricter federal safety and financial liability standards.

BE IT FINALLY RESOLVED, that this Resolution shall be communicated to the Governor of Louisiana, the Secretary of the LDENR, the Administrator of the EPA, and all relevant state and federal legislators representing St. Martin Parish.

This Resolution having been submitted to a vote, the vote thereon was as follows:

YEAS:	Hoyt Louviere, Carla JeanBatiste, Tangie Narcisse, David Poirier, Chris Tauzin, Corey Melancon, Vincent Alexander and Ben Clay.
NAYS:	None.
ABSTAIN:	None.
ABSENT:	Chris Courville (excused).

And the Resolution was declared adopted this 3rd day of March, 2026.

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I, **BROOKE THIBODEAUX, CLERK OF THE ST. MARTIN PARISH COUNCIL**, do hereby certify that this is a true and correct copy of the Resolution adopted by the St. Martin Parish Council, in Regular Session convened on the 3rd day of March, 2026, at which meeting a quorum was present.

GIVEN UNDER MY OFFICIAL SIGNATURE AND SEAL OF OFFICE, this 4th day of March, 2026, St. Martinville, Louisiana.

Brooke Thibodeaux

BROOKE THIBODEAUX, CLERK
ST. MARTIN PARISH COUNCIL